

Ethan Zaruba-Walker

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September 16, 2026

Dear Ms. Namba,

I am applying for the Assistant Montessori Guide maternity-leave substitute at Cosmos Montessori, covering October 2026 through July 2027, and remaining available as an on-call substitute after. I live in Emeryville and can work full-time school hours in the Castro. I want this teacher-owned home: at most six toddlers, daily outside walks, and Zero Waste practice, under your AML-trained lead.

I am applying to assist, not to lead. I will take your guidance, wait before I act, and follow the pace you set with each child. Daily outside walks are the part of the day I can meet from a life already spent outdoors on the Bay, without pretending I have classroom hours.

I have no classroom, camp, tutoring, or youth-program tenure, and no years working with children ages 0 to 3. I do not hold AML or AMS credentials, a California teaching credential, or the six ECE units your posting requires, and I do not yet have pediatric CPR and First Aid. If you hire an assistant who still needs those credentials, I will complete pediatric CPR and First Aid before starting, complete the ECE units on a timeline you set, and finish Live Scan, TB, MMR, Tdap, and the other California childcare licensing documents you require. Your posting also offers Montessori professional development in an authentic environment. That is the training I am asking to do, not a claim that I have already done it.

What I can bring while I earn those credentials:

- Cognitive Science: Certificate of Cognitive Science with a B.S. in Information Science, including graduate seminar PSYC 7215. I watch how people learn and wait before jumping in. That practice is with adults, not infants and toddlers.
- Receiving guidance: Your posting asks for someone who can take feedback in a small team. I write down what I am taught, revise when corrected, and stay until the person who owns the work is satisfied. EZ-AI is problem-first training for adult domain experts, not work with children.
- Calm, outdoor, multilingual: conversational Spanish; EMT (2024) for composure, not as pediatric CPR. I live aboard a sailboat on the Bay and am at ease on daily outside walks.

I can commit to the full October 2026 through July 2027 cover, Monday through Friday, and to staying on as an on-call substitute after. I would welcome a conversation about assisting in your toddler community under your lead.

Thank you for your time. I look forward to hearing from you.

Sincerely,

Ethan Zaruba-Walker